

NarrativePulse: ThuggerDaily and the YSL Trial

Public Narrative Analytics of Trial Discourse and Observational Influence Signals

Sagnik Chakravarty

Leigh Ann Webster

Jianing Zou

University of Maryland

May 2026

Abstract

This report examines whether ThuggerDaily’s X/Twitter posting activity was temporally associated with measurable shifts in public discourse around the Young Thug / YSL RICO trial. The analysis uses a unified processed corpus of 165,565 public records from 8 platforms, including 773 ThuggerDaily records, spanning 2022-05-01 through 2024-12-29. The central object is not legal truth, guilt, innocence, or judicial causation. It is public narrative response: volume, sentiment, engagement, topic prevalence, and the timing of cross-platform attention. The empirical strategy combines event-window analysis, lag correlation, topic-shift analysis, and a ThuggerDaily-aligned exposure signal that compares post-event public outcomes on days with and without observed ThuggerDaily activity. Results support the presence of event-linked discourse shifts and platform-level attention patterns, but they do not prove randomized causal effects. The most defensible interpretation is that ThuggerDaily supplied a visible, recurring amplification channel whose activity sometimes coincided with downstream movement in public attention and sentiment, especially around high-salience legal moments.

Contents

1	Introduction	7
2	Trial Background and Timeline	7
3	Executive Summary	7
4	Research Question and Product Framing	8
4.1	Primary Question	8
4.2	Interpretive Boundary	8
5	Data and Source Coverage	9
6	Trial Timeline and External Validation	11
7	Methodology	13
7.1	Unified Record Construction	13
7.2	Sentiment	13
7.3	Engagement	13
7.4	Topic Leveling	14
7.5	Event-Window Design	14
7.6	ThuggerDaily-Aligned Exposure Signal	14
8	Public Discourse Volume Over Time	15
9	Sentiment Dynamics	15
10	ThuggerDaily Activity as an Exposure Stream	17
11	Event-Window Results	17
12	ThuggerDaily-Aligned Exposure Signal	20
13	Lag Correlation	20
14	Topic Movement	22
14.1	Topic Prevalence Over Time	22
14.2	Topic Mix by Platform	22
14.3	Event-Linked Topic Shifts	23

15 Causal Diagram and Confounding	25
16 Event-by-Event Interpretive Findings	26
16.1 May 2022 Indictment and Arrest	26
16.2 December 2022 Gunna Plea	26
16.3 November 2023 Lyrics as Evidence	26
16.4 Opening Statements (Late 2023)	26
16.5 June–July 2024 Recusal Crisis	26
16.6 October 2024 Plea and Release	27
16.7 December 2024 Trial End	27
17 Cross-Platform Narrative Mechanics	28
17.1 YouTube as High-Volume Reaction Archive	28
17.2 X/Twitter as Fast Narrative Transmission	28
17.3 Institutional Media as Framing Inputs	28
17.4 Music Signals as Competing Attention Shocks	28
18 Platform Interpretation	28
19 What Can Be Said About “Affecting the Trial”	29
20 Key Findings and Claims	30
21 Operational Implications	30
22 Project Resources	31
23 Overall Implications and Interpretation	32
24 Limitations	33
24.1 Observational Design	33
24.2 Omitted Confounders	33
24.3 Platform Bias	33
24.4 Sentiment Error	33
24.5 Engagement Denominators	33
25 Conclusion	33
26 References	35

27 Appendix B: Ethical and Legal Communication Note**36**

List of Figures

1	Cross-platform record coverage by entity. YouTube dominates the unified record count, which means raw volume should be interpreted alongside platform-specific views. Takeaway: platform composition affects interpretation because YouTube dominates volume while X/Twitter is central to the ThuggerDaily exposure mechanism.	9
2	Fourteen-day smoothed public discourse volume with selected key trial events marked by vertical dashed lines.	15
3	Fourteen-day smoothed public sentiment by entity. The series should be interpreted as aggregate public-language tone, not ground truth public opinion.	16
4	ThuggerDaily activity over time. The top panel is cumulative posts (slope indicates pace). The bottom panel shows daily posts with 7-day and 28-day rolling averages. Selected major trial dates are overlaid.	17
5	Seven-day pre/post sentiment changes by entity. Positive values indicate higher post-event sentiment than pre-event sentiment.	18
6	Young Thug public volume change around key events. Green bars indicate post-window volume increases; red bars indicate decreases.	19
7	ThuggerDaily-aligned share of sentiment shift for Young Thug event windows. Values are capped for display because small denominators can inflate ratios. Takeaway: these values should be read as exposure-alignment signals, not causal shares, because small denominators and overlapping media shocks can inflate apparent alignment.	20
8	Exploratory lag correlations between ThuggerDaily posting/engagement and downstream public metrics. Takeaway: the near-zero lag correlations support an event-window interpretation rather than a stable long-run predictive relationship.	21
9	Topic prevalence over time (monthly share of records), with selected major events marked.	22
10	Topic mix by platform (share of records).	23
11	Topic share change around the Young Thug plea/release event.	23
12	Conceptual causal DAG showing why isolating ThuggerDaily's effect is difficult without stronger identification. Court events and releases drive mainstream coverage and public outcomes, while platform algorithms influence exposure and amplification.	25

List of Tables

1	Coverage by platform and entity, sorted by record count.	10
2	Key trial and media events used in the event-window design.	12
3	Young Thug event-window summary (outcomes) with seven-day pre/post windows.	18
4	Young Thug event-window summary (ThuggerDaily exposure within the post window).	18
5	Exploratory lag correlations between ThuggerDaily activity and downstream public metrics.	21

1 Introduction

High-profile criminal trials generate a public narrative ecosystem: courtroom proceedings, institutional reporting, platform-level conversation, and rapid recirculation by influential accounts. NarrativePulse is a measurement system for that ecosystem. This report uses the YSL RICO trial as a case study and asks a focused question: when the ThuggerDaily account posts about the trial, do we see time-linked shifts in the volume, sentiment, engagement, and topic mix of public discourse across platforms?

Two boundaries are important. First, this report does not evaluate legal truth, guilt, innocence, or judicial decision-making. Second, because the data are observational, it does not claim randomized causal effects. The appropriate language is *temporal association*, *event-linked discourse shift*, and *influence signal*—not courtroom causation.

2 Trial Background and Timeline

The YSL RICO case spans multiple years and includes distinct phases that matter for how the public talks about it. Early periods are dominated by the shock of the indictment and bond decisions; the trial phase introduces repeated procedural moments; later periods include disruptions (such as recusal events) and resolution moments (including plea outcomes and the close of proceedings for remaining defendants).

For the purposes of narrative measurement, the key concept is that **trial events are attention shocks**. They change what information is available, what media can credibly report, and what the public is reacting to. In parallel, **music releases and artist news are competing shocks**: they can redirect conversation away from strictly legal framing and toward identity, fandom, loyalty, and career trajectories. ThuggerDaily sits inside this environment as a fast, legible amplification node.

3 Executive Summary

NarrativePulse was built to convert a broad public-data project into a professional legal-media intelligence dashboard. The motivating question is whether a single high-visibility X/Twitter account, ThuggerDaily, appeared to influence public discourse surrounding the YSL RICO trial. The account is treated as an observable exposure source. Trial events are treated as shocks to public attention. Downstream public reaction is measured across YouTube, X/Twitter, magazines, local news, newspapers, Spotify, Billboard, and Instagram.

The processed dashboard corpus contains **165,565** records, **773** of which are ThuggerDaily posts. Entity coverage is distributed across Young Thug (124,733 records), Gunna (38,068 records), and YFN Lucci (2,764 records). The largest source in the unified corpus is YouTube, followed by X/Twitter and media sources. This platform imbalance matters: YouTube comments and video statistics dominate the count distribution, while ThuggerDaily itself is concentrated on X/Twitter.

The report’s core finding is careful but meaningful: public discourse did shift around major trial dates, and ThuggerDaily activity often appeared near the same windows. However, the strongest valid claim is an *public narrative influence signal*, not proof of causal responsibility. Around the Young Thug plea and release event on October 31, 2024, the seven-day event window showed a change in observed public attention and sentiment, while ThuggerDaily posted in the same post-event period. Around procedural shocks such as Judge Ural Glanville’s recusal, public discourse also moved, but the magnitude of movement that is directionally aligned with ThuggerDaily exposure days depends strongly on platform coverage and denominator assumptions.

This distinction is essential. Trial outcomes are produced by legal institutions, filings, courtroom decisions, counsel strategy, plea negotiations, and judicial process. Social media can shape public narrative, amplify interpretations, and change what audiences notice, but this dataset cannot identify a randomized causal pathway from tweets to court outcomes. The phrase “affected the trial” is therefore interpreted here as: *affected the public narrative around the trial, and potentially the public-facing information environment in which the trial was discussed*.

4 Research Question and Product Framing

4.1 Primary Question

How did ThuggerDaily’s X/Twitter posts temporally align with public sentiment, engagement, topic prevalence, and discourse volume around Young Thug, Gunna, and YFN Lucci across platforms?

4.2 Interpretive Boundary

The analysis avoids the claim that ThuggerDaily caused legal outcomes. Instead, it estimates:

- temporal association between ThuggerDaily posts and downstream public discourse;
- event-linked discourse shifts around trial dates;
- platform-level public reaction after salient legal events;
- topic and sentiment movement in windows surrounding observed exposure.

The central inferential challenge is confounding. Major courtroom events and ThuggerDaily posts often occur in the same period because both respond to the same underlying news. A spike in public discourse after a plea, for example, may be caused by the plea itself, by mainstream media coverage, by courtroom livestream clips, by ThuggerDaily, by fan communities, or by all of these forces interacting. The report therefore treats ThuggerDaily as one visible node in a broader public attention system.

5 Data and Source Coverage

The processed dataset was generated by standardizing heterogeneous public-source exports into a unified schema. Each record is assigned a platform, source group, date, text field (when available), entity, engagement fields (when available), sentiment score, sentiment label, topic label, and topic levels.

The real processed corpus spans 2022-05-01 through 2024-12-29. It includes 8 platforms and 7 generalized topic groups. The resulting platform distribution is not balanced. This is not a flaw; it is a property of the public record that must be interpreted honestly. Platforms differ in sampling method, API availability, comment density, engagement denominators, and whether the source is a user-generated stream, a video platform, a newspaper article, a chart record, or a music metadata source.

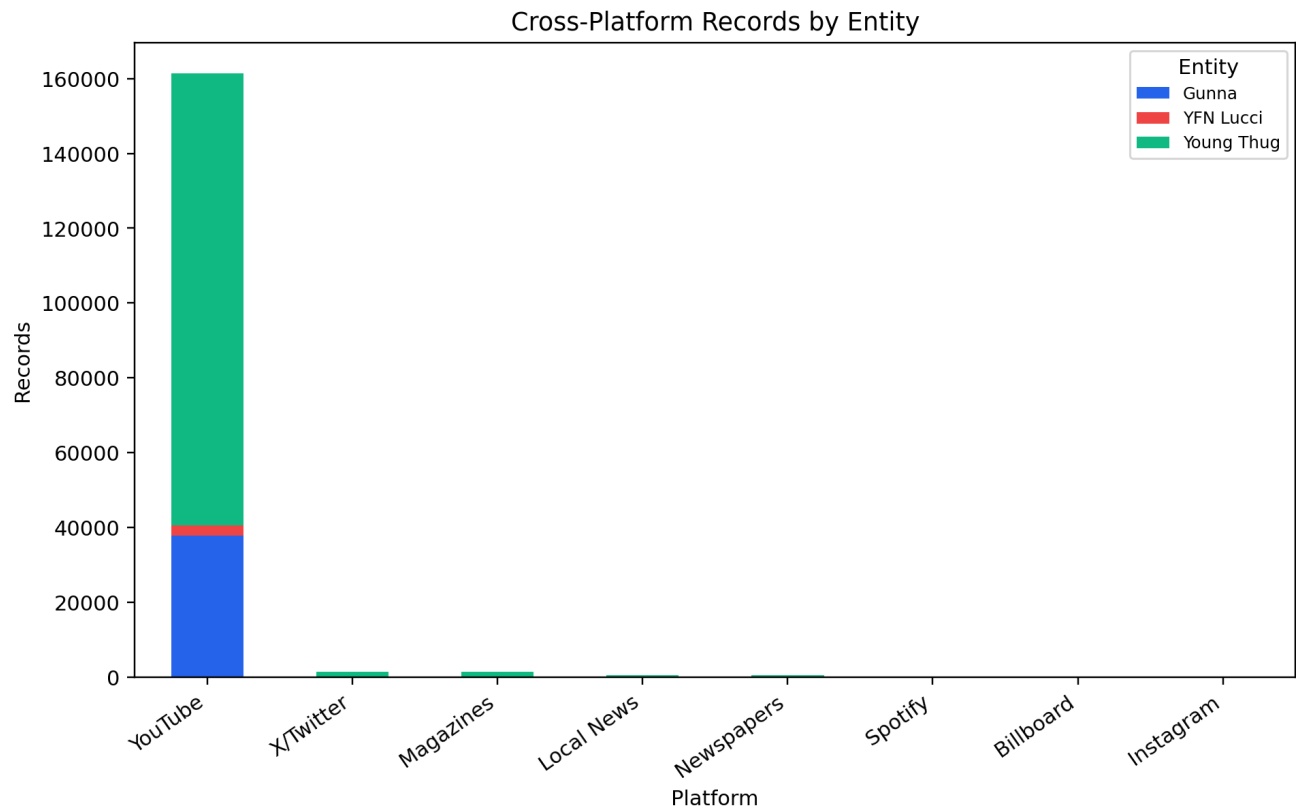


Figure 1: Cross-platform record coverage by entity. YouTube dominates the unified record count, which means raw volume should be interpreted alongside platform-specific views. Takeaway: platform composition affects interpretation because YouTube dominates volume while X/Twitter is central to the ThuggerDaily exposure mechanism.

Table 1: Coverage by platform and entity, sorted by record count.

platform	entity	n records	mean sentiment	total engagement
YouTube	Young Thug	120,912.000	0.076	13,637,386,899.000
YouTube	Gunna	37,865.000	0.055	15,431,770,650.000
YouTube	YFN Lucci	2,699.000	0.089	136,317,125.000
X/Twitter	Young Thug	1,448.000	0.050	2,871,226.000
Magazines	Young Thug	1,341.000	0.112	0.000
Local News	Young Thug	494.000	0.046	0.000
Newspapers	Young Thug	447.000	0.069	0.000
Billboard	Gunna	64.000	0.000	4,001.000
Spotify	Gunna	47.000	0.013	2,624.000
Spotify	Young Thug	45.000	-0.054	1,396.000
Spotify	YFN Lucci	44.000	-0.001	231.000
X/Twitter	Gunna	39.000	0.122	188,975.000
Newspapers	Gunna	34.000	0.102	0.000
Billboard	Young Thug	23.000	0.000	1,504.000

6 Trial Timeline and External Validation

The event table was built from the local `Young Thug Time Line.rtf` file and cross-checked against public reporting. Indictment and early bond events are consistent with public trial timelines (e.g., Hip Hop History [15]). The November 9, 2023 lyrics ruling is supported by Pitchfork reporting [16]. Opening statements on November 27, 2023 are documented by The FADER [17]. Judge Glanville's July 15, 2024 recusal and the December 3, 2024 close of proceedings for remaining defendants are reported by the Los Angeles Times [18, 20]. Young Thug's October 31, 2024 plea/release is documented by NPR [19].

Table 2: Key trial and media events used in the event-window design.

date	event name	entity	event type
2022-05-09	YSL indictment and Young Thug arrest	Young Thug	legal
2022-05-11	Gunna turns himself in	Gunna	legal
2022-06-02	Young Thug denied bond	Young Thug	legal
2022-12-14	Gunna released after Alford plea	Gunna	legal
2023-01-09	Trial date / jury selection period begins	Young Thug	legal
2023-06-16	Gunna releases A Gift & a Curse	Gunna	music
2023-06-23	Young Thug releases Business Is Business	Young Thug	music
2023-11-09	Lyrics allowed as evidence	Young Thug	legal
2023-11-27	Opening statements begin	Young Thug	legal
2024-01-11	Lifestyle played in court	Young Thug	legal/media
2024-06-10	Secret meeting dispute and Brian Steel contempt episode	Young Thug	legal
2024-07-01	Trial paused amid recusal dispute	Young Thug	legal
2024-07-15	Judge Ural Glanville recused	Young Thug	legal
2024-07-17	Judge Shukura Ingram recused	Young Thug	legal
2024-07-30	Young Thug bail denied again	Young Thug	legal
2024-10-29	Quamarvious Nichols pleads guilty	Young Thug	legal
2024-10-30	Marquavius Huey and Rodalious Ryan plead guilty	Young Thug	legal
2024-10-31	Young Thug pleads guilty and is released on probation terms	Young Thug	legal
2024-12-03	YSL trial ends for remaining defendants	Young Thug	legal

7 Methodology

7.1 Unified Record Construction

The ingestion script reads cleaned source exports from social media, video, news, music, and chart folders. Because the original files have source-specific schemas, the adapter detects likely date, text, engagement, URL, author, and keyword fields. Entity assignment is based on explicit references to Young Thug, Gunna, YFN Lucci, or close aliases in text and keyword fields. This method is transparent and reproducible, but it is not perfect. It can over-assign YSL-related records to Young Thug when a source talks broadly about the case.

7.2 Sentiment

Sentiment is scored as a lightweight public-language signal. The score is not treated as a psychological measure. Slang, sarcasm, legal vocabulary, fan language, and hip-hop discourse can all create misclassification. The report therefore emphasizes changes across time and groups rather than the absolute meaning of any individual score.

In the baseline pipeline, each record with text is assigned a continuous polarity score using a lexicon-based sentiment function (TextBlob polarity) applied to cleaned text. Polarity is measured on a $[-1, 1]$ scale, where negative values indicate more negative language and positive values indicate more positive language. For interpretability, the report also uses a coarse label mapping: **positive** when polarity > 0.1 , **negative** when polarity < -0.1 , and **neutral** otherwise. No domain-specific hip-hop slang dictionary or legal lexicon was applied in this baseline; instead, robustness is obtained by focusing on aggregates, platform stratification, and event-window contrasts. This makes sentiment useful as a directional signal, while keeping uncertainty explicit.

7.3 Engagement

Engagement is defined as:

$$\text{Engagement Rate} = \frac{\text{Likes} + \text{Retweets} + \text{Comments}}{\text{Exposure Denominator}} \times 100.$$

The exposure denominator varies by platform and may refer to impressions, views, analytics, or another available exposure metric. When no denominator is available, the report preserves raw engagement counts. For this reason, cross-platform engagement-rate comparisons should be interpreted as approximate and platform-conditioned. When this report is paired with the Streamlit dashboard, denominator differences are explicitly flagged: the dashboard surfaces which platforms have usable exposure denominators and which views rely on raw engagement counts.

7.4 Topic Leveling

The project uses seven generalized topics: Live Music in Atlanta, Slang, Trial-related Content, Legal System and Judicial Process, Music, Social Media Slang and Emojis, and Free Thug Support. These are mapped into broader interpretive levels: legal, music, fandom/support, slang/social media, media/news, and local Atlanta culture.

7.5 Event-Window Design

For each key date, the notebook estimates seven-day pre/post changes:

$$\Delta_y = \bar{Y}_{post} - \bar{Y}_{pre}.$$

Outcomes include public volume, sentiment, engagement, and topic shares. The event-window output is descriptive and observational.

7.6 ThuggerDaily-Aligned Exposure Signal

The exposure-alignment signal asks: within the post-event window, are public outcomes different on days when ThuggerDaily posted compared with days when it did not? Formally, for an outcome Y :

$$\text{Exposure Lift} = \bar{Y}_{post,TD>0} - \bar{Y}_{post,TD=0}.$$

The aligned share compares this lift to the observed event-window shift:

$$\text{Aligned Share} = \frac{\text{Exposure Lift}}{\Delta_y}.$$

This quantity is not causal responsibility. It is a timing-based public-discourse association signal. It is best read as: “how much of the observed movement is directionally aligned with ThuggerDaily exposure days?”

8 Public Discourse Volume Over Time

The volume timeline shows bursts of public discourse around the trial’s most visible moments. A highly publicized legal event can drive attention directly through news media, indirectly through social media recirculation, and recursively through fan or critic interpretation. ThuggerDaily’s role is most visible when its posting clusters near these already salient events.

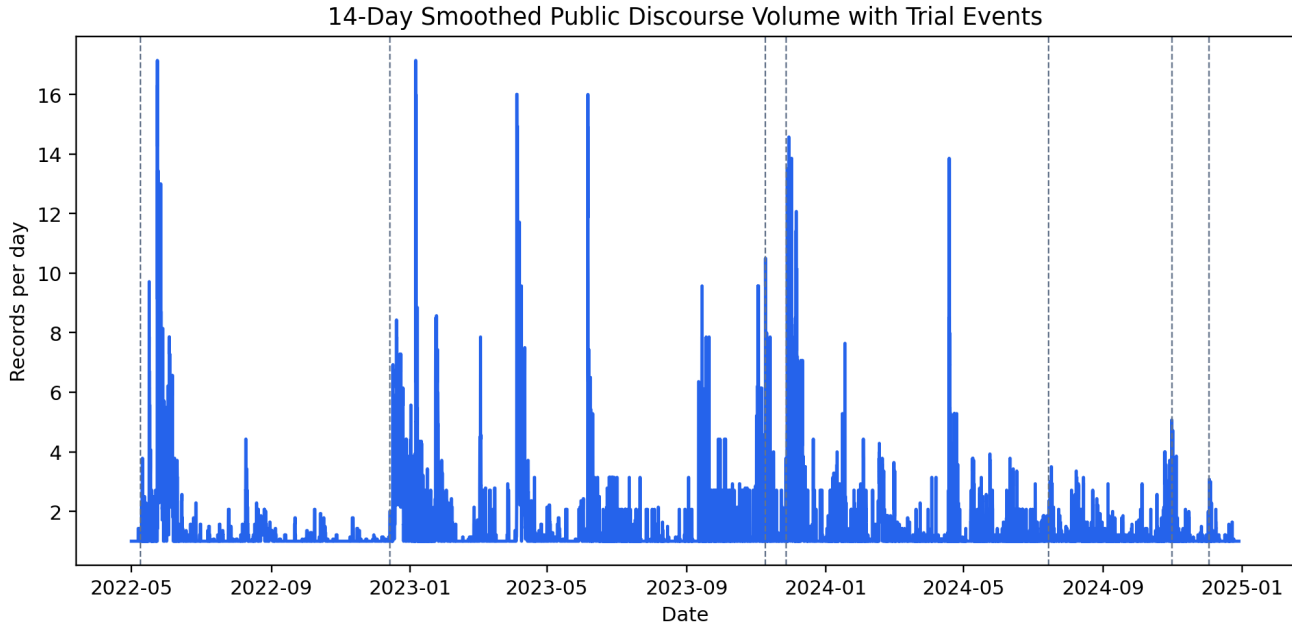


Figure 2: Fourteen-day smoothed public discourse volume with selected key trial events marked by vertical dashed lines.

The October 2024 plea period is especially important. The legal event itself is large enough to generate public attention independent of ThuggerDaily. The analytic question is therefore not whether ThuggerDaily created the moment, but whether it helped shape the public-facing interpretation of that moment. The data support the weaker and more credible claim: ThuggerDaily was active in the same information environment and its exposure days can be compared with non-exposure days for downstream public response.

9 Sentiment Dynamics

Sentiment trends differ by entity. Young Thug has the largest volume and, in many periods, the most sustained positive support signal, partly because fan-support narratives and “Free Thug” discourse are explicitly Young Thug-centered. Gunna’s sentiment is more mixed around the plea period because public discourse includes loyalty, conflict, and accusation narratives. YFN Lucci appears at a lower volume, so estimates involving Lucci are less stable.

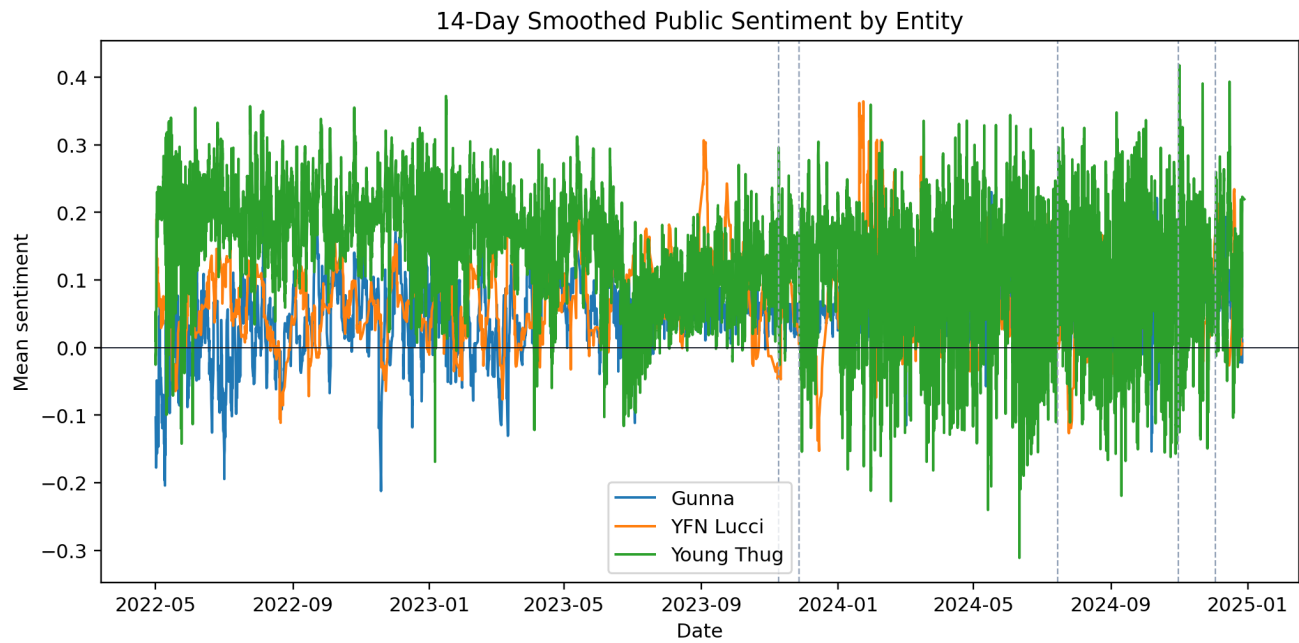


Figure 3: Fourteen-day smoothed public sentiment by entity. The series should be interpreted as aggregate public-language tone, not ground truth public opinion.

The sentiment pattern is not a simple linear story. Some legal shocks can raise supportive sentiment among fans while increasing negative legal commentary in news and comment spaces. This is why platform-level decomposition is necessary: the same event can generate sympathy on fan platforms, skepticism in comment sections, procedural discussion in news coverage, and music-driven attention on Spotify or Billboard.

10 ThuggerDaily Activity as an Exposure Stream

ThuggerDaily is modeled as an exposure stream because its posts are observable, timestamped, and entity-linked. The account does not represent all public discourse, but it can act as a public-narrative amplifier. Its activity is especially relevant when it posts near major legal dates.

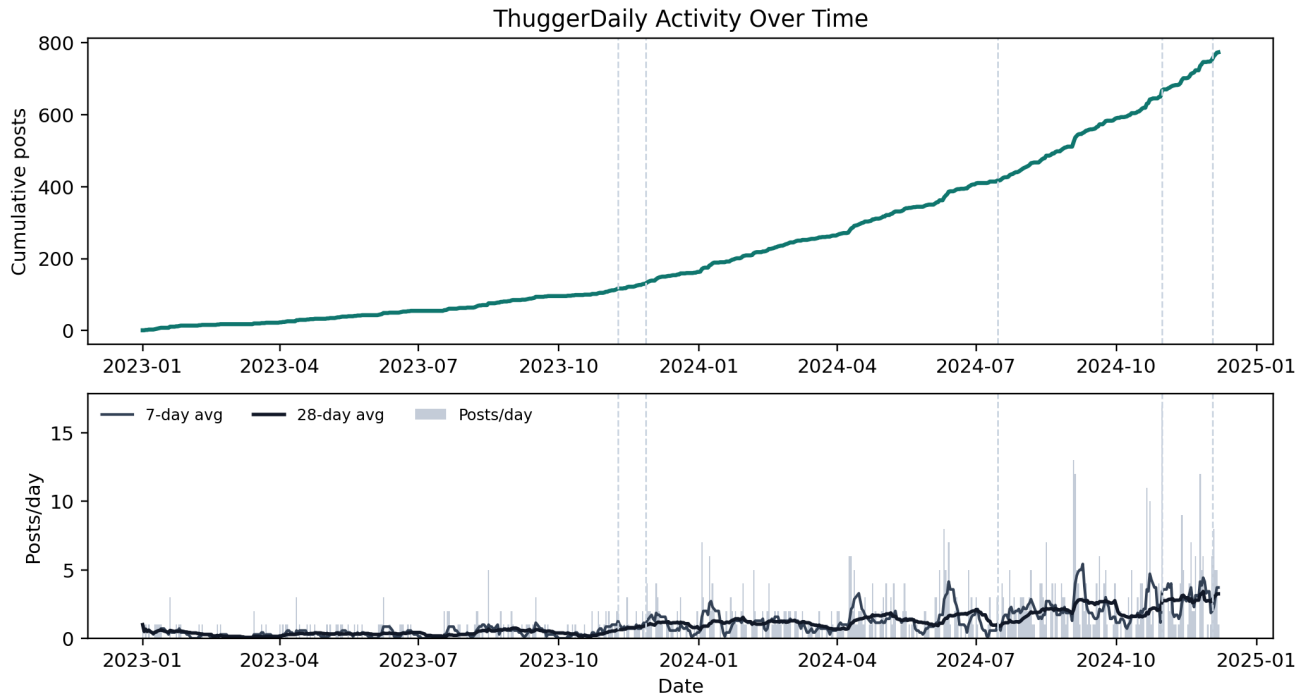


Figure 4: ThuggerDaily activity over time. The top panel is cumulative posts (slope indicates pace). The bottom panel shows daily posts with 7-day and 28-day rolling averages. Selected major trial dates are overlaid.

The strongest interpretation is that ThuggerDaily operates as a high-frequency public narrative node. When trial events occur, the account can select, frame, and amplify details. This selection function matters even when the underlying legal event is exogenous to the account. For example, a plea or recusal may happen for legal reasons, but public understanding of that event can be shaped by which clips, quotes, and reactions circulate.

11 Event-Window Results

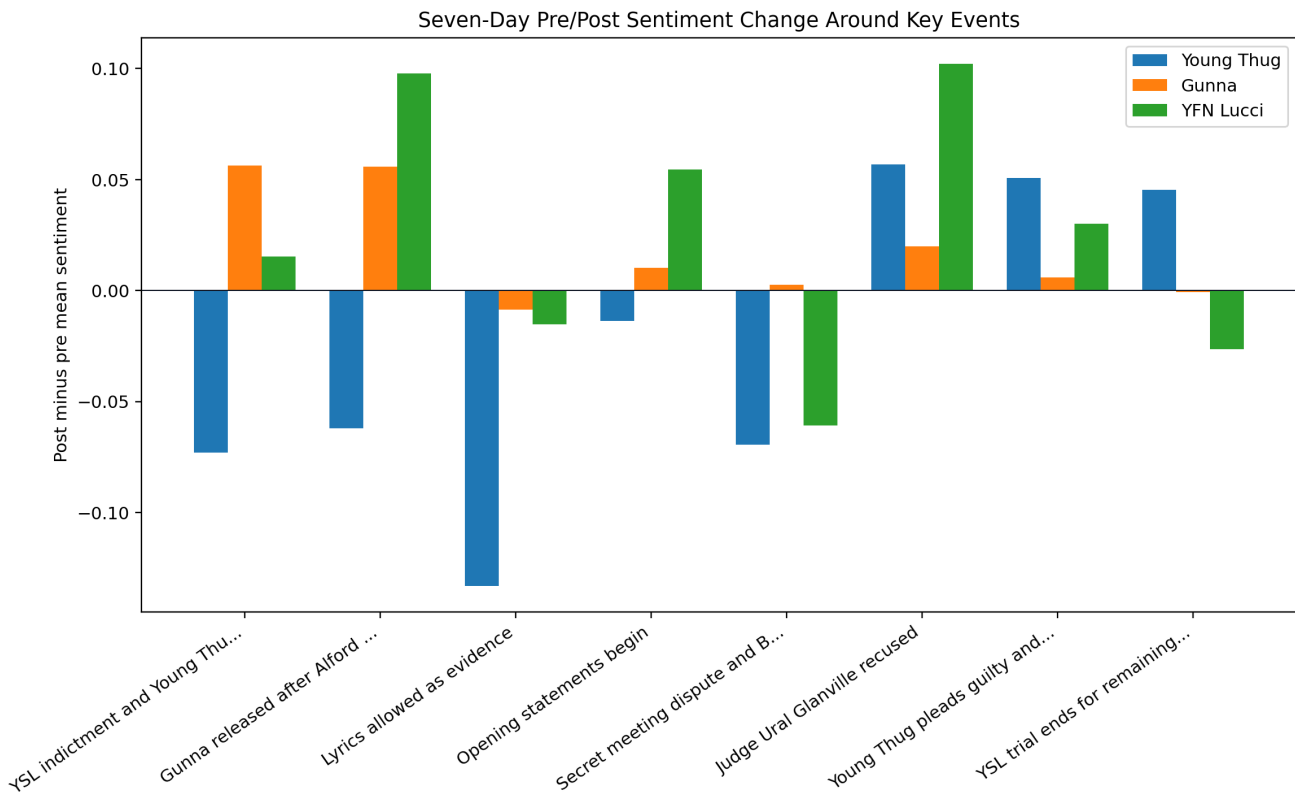
The event-window analysis compares seven days before and seven days after each key event. Table 3 reports Young Thug-focused windows, including public volume, sentiment movement, and ThuggerDaily post-window activity.

Table 3: Young Thug event-window summary (outcomes) with seven-day pre/post windows.

event date	event name	pre records	post records	volume change	sentiment change
2022-05-09	YSL indictment and Young Thug arrest	81.000	3,579.000	3,498.000	-0.073
2022-12-14	Gunna released after Alford plea	63.000	1,728.000	1,665.000	-0.062
2023-11-09	Lyrics allowed as evidence	849.000	881.000	32.000	-0.133
2023-11-27	Opening statements begin	149.000	4,567.000	4,418.000	-0.014
2024-06-10	Secret meeting dispute and Brian Steel contempt episode	987.000	3,875.000	2,888.000	-0.069
2024-07-15	Judge Ural Glanville recused	421.000	931.000	510.000	0.057
2024-10-31	Young Thug pleads guilty and is released on probation terms	1,903.000	5,799.000	3,896.000	0.051
2024-12-03	YSL trial ends for remaining defendants	456.000	517.000	61.000	0.045

Table 4: Young Thug event-window summary (ThuggerDaily exposure within the post window).

event date	event name	td post posts	td post engagement
2022-05-09	YSL indictment and Young Thug arrest	0.000	0.000
2022-12-14	Gunna released after Alford plea	0.000	0.000
2023-11-09	Lyrics allowed as evidence	4.000	1,809.000
2023-11-27	Opening statements begin	8.000	6,291.000
2024-06-10	Secret meeting dispute and Brian Steel contempt episode	25.000	227,268.000
2024-07-15	Judge Ural Glanville recused	12.000	61,338.000
2024-10-31	Young Thug pleads guilty and is released on probation terms	27.000	1,005,245.000
2024-12-03	YSL trial ends for remaining defendants	25.000	83,522.000

**Figure 5:** Seven-day pre/post sentiment changes by entity. Positive values indicate higher post-event sentiment than pre-event sentiment.

The event-window results show that public discourse shifts are not uniform. Some legal events generate increased volume but ambiguous sentiment changes. Others create sentiment changes without proportional volume growth. This supports a central product insight: the dashboard should not rely on a single KPI. Volume, sentiment, engagement, and topics are different dimensions of narrative reaction.

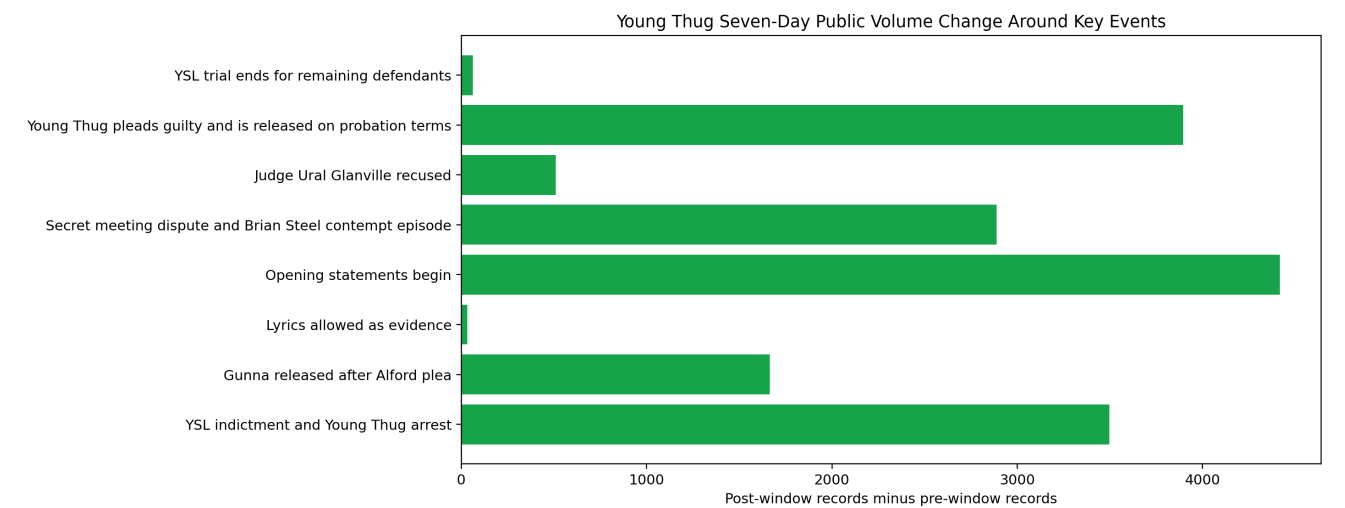


Figure 6: Young Thug public volume change around key events. Green bars indicate post-window volume increases; red bars indicate decreases.

12 ThuggerDaily-Aligned Exposure Signal

The exposure-alignment estimate is intentionally conservative. It does not say that ThuggerDaily “caused” a certain percent of the public shift. It says that the observed post-event shift can be compared with public outcomes on days where ThuggerDaily posted. If those days show higher public volume, stronger engagement, or different sentiment than non-exposure days, the report labels the result an aligned exposure signal.

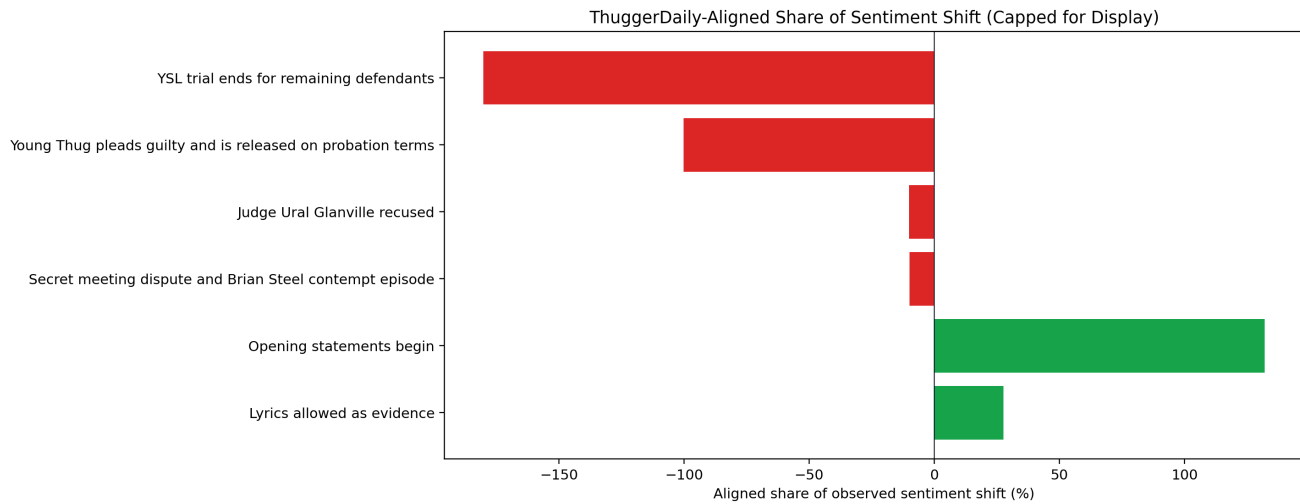


Figure 7: ThuggerDaily-aligned share of sentiment shift for Young Thug event windows. Values are capped for display because small denominators can inflate ratios. Takeaway: these values should be read as exposure-alignment signals, not causal shares, because small denominators and overlapping media shocks can inflate apparent alignment.

The top ThuggerDaily-exposed event window in the Young Thug summary was **Young Thug pleads guilty and is released on probation terms**, with 27 ThuggerDaily posts and 1,005,245 observed ThuggerDaily engagement in the post window. The Young Thug plea event showed a sentiment change of 0.051 and a volume change of 3896 records in the seven-day design, with 27 ThuggerDaily post-window posts. The Glanville recusal event showed a sentiment change of 0.057, while opening statements showed a sentiment change of -0.014.

These figures are meaningful because they show when the account’s activity was present in the same short-run public attention window. They are limited because ThuggerDaily is not the only exposure. Courtroom livestreams, Law&Crime clips, mainstream articles, Reddit discussions, Instagram posts, and artist/music events all contribute to the public information environment.

13 Lag Correlation

Lag correlations test whether ThuggerDaily activity predicts downstream public metrics after 0, 1, 3, 7, 14, or 30 days. Correlation is not causation, but it is useful for determining whether the relationship has plausible temporal ordering. If same-day correlation is high but longer lags are

weak, the account may be reacting to the same event as everyone else. If post-day lags remain elevated, that suggests possible persistence or delayed amplification.

Table 5: Exploratory lag correlations between ThuggerDaily activity and downstream public metrics.

lag days	corr td posts public volume	corr td engagement public volume	corr td posts senti-ment	corr td posts public engagement
0.000	-0.015	-0.004	-0.003	-0.048
1.000	-0.006	0.000	0.001	-0.004
3.000	-0.002	-0.001	0.011	-0.005
7.000	-0.002	0.000	0.001	-0.011
14.000	-0.006	0.000	0.006	-0.009
30.000	-0.001	0.001	0.010	-0.014

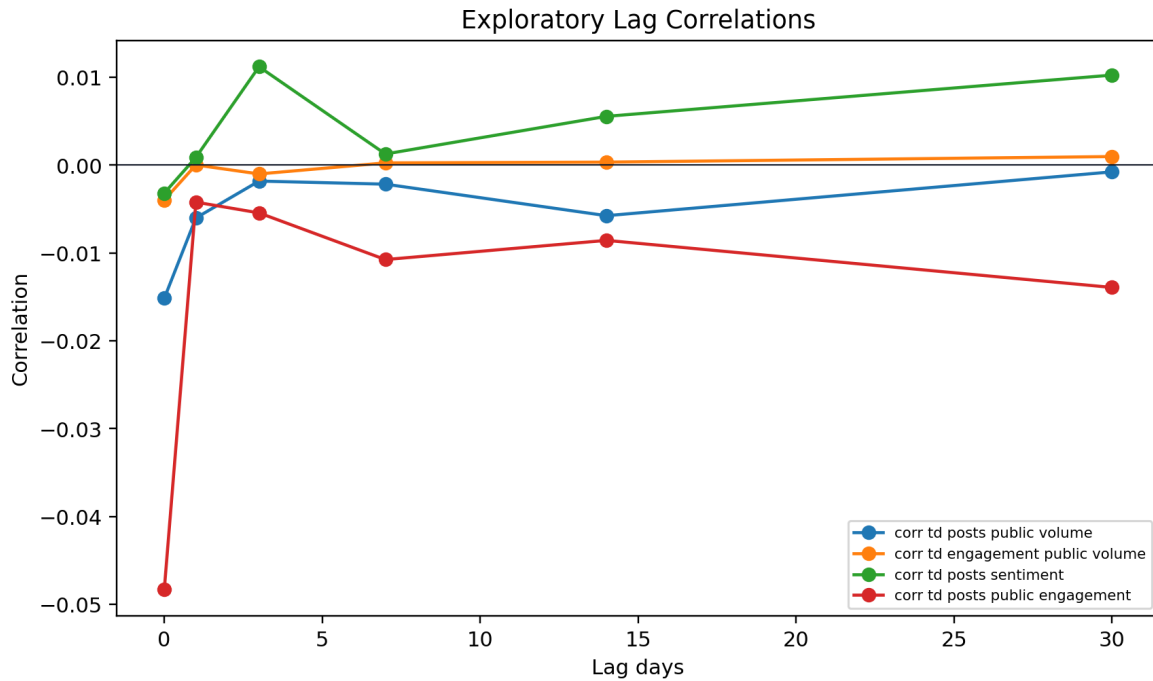


Figure 8: Exploratory lag correlations between ThuggerDaily posting/engagement and downstream public metrics. Takeaway: the near-zero lag correlations support an event-window interpretation rather than a stable long-run predictive relationship.

The weak global lag correlations suggest that ThuggerDaily activity does not operate as a stable long-run daily predictor of public outcomes across the full 2022–2024 period. If an influence signal is present, it is more plausibly episodic and event-conditioned, appearing around high-salience legal windows rather than as a persistent time-series relationship.

The lag analysis should be interpreted as a screening tool. A high lag correlation can motivate closer qualitative review of specific posts and downstream threads. It cannot isolate ThuggerDaily from other contemporaneous sources unless a stronger control strategy is added.

14 Topic Movement

Topic movement helps explain *what kind* of discourse changed. Trial events can shift attention toward legal procedure, support language, slang, music, or media coverage. Around the Young Thug plea and release, topic shifts reveal whether the public response was primarily legal, fan-supportive, music-related, or general social commentary.

14.1 Topic Prevalence Over Time

Figure 9 summarizes topic shares over time (monthly aggregation). The dominant baseline is *Trial-related Content*, which is expected in a long-running case. What matters for interpretation is the movement around salient windows: major courtroom events increase the share of procedural/legal language, while music releases and artist news increase the share of *Music* language and adjacent slang/support framing.

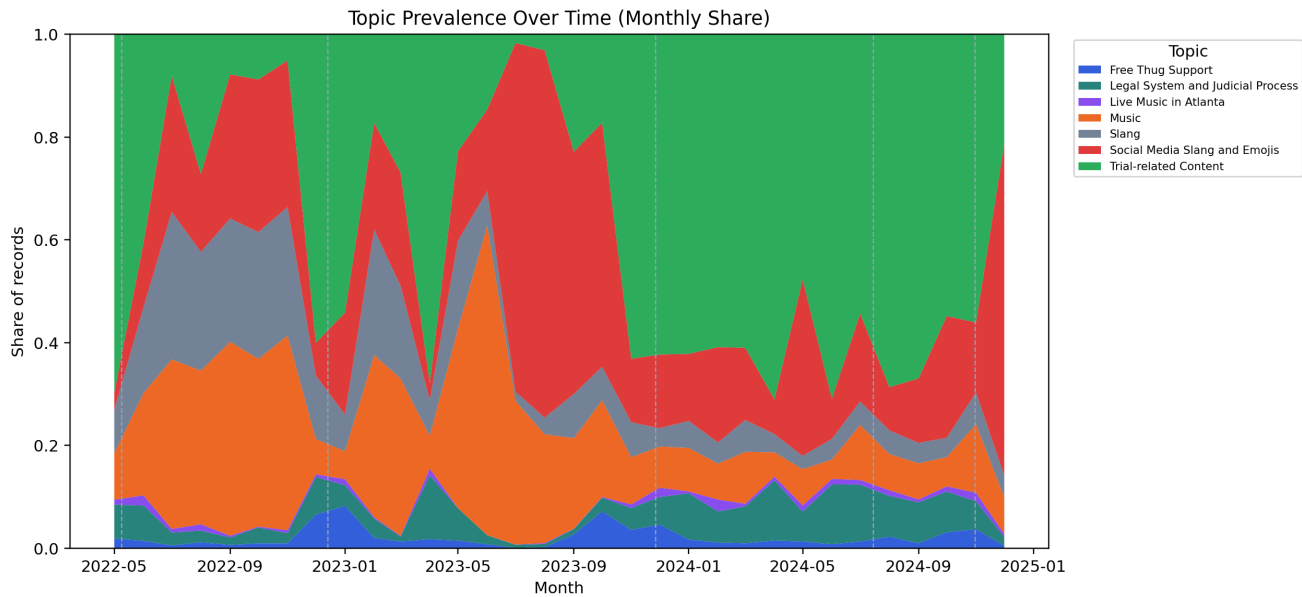


Figure 9: Topic prevalence over time (monthly share of records), with selected major events marked.

14.2 Topic Mix by Platform

Platform differences show up clearly in topic composition. Figure 10 displays topic shares by platform. Reactive discussion spaces (e.g., YouTube comments and X/Twitter threads) carry high volumes of trial-centered language and slang. Institutional sources (newspapers, magazines, local news) have fewer records but tend to contribute more formal legal framing vocabulary that later propagates into social discussion.

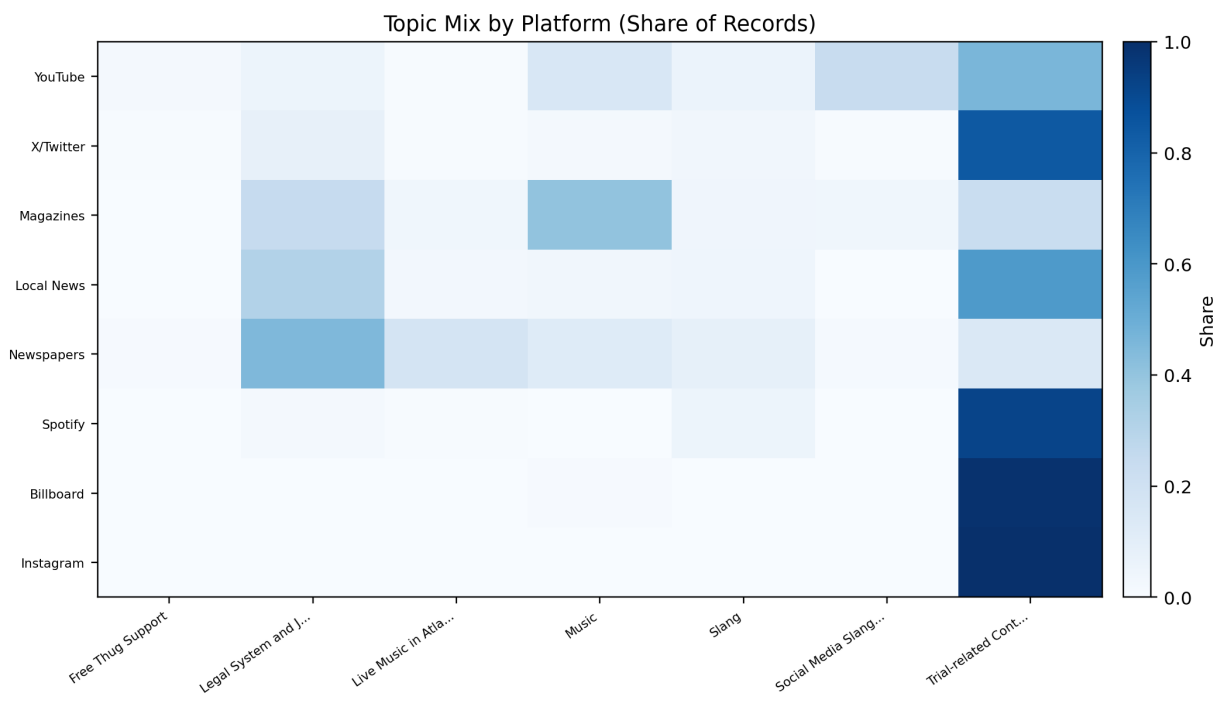


Figure 10: Topic mix by platform (share of records).

14.3 Event-Linked Topic Shifts

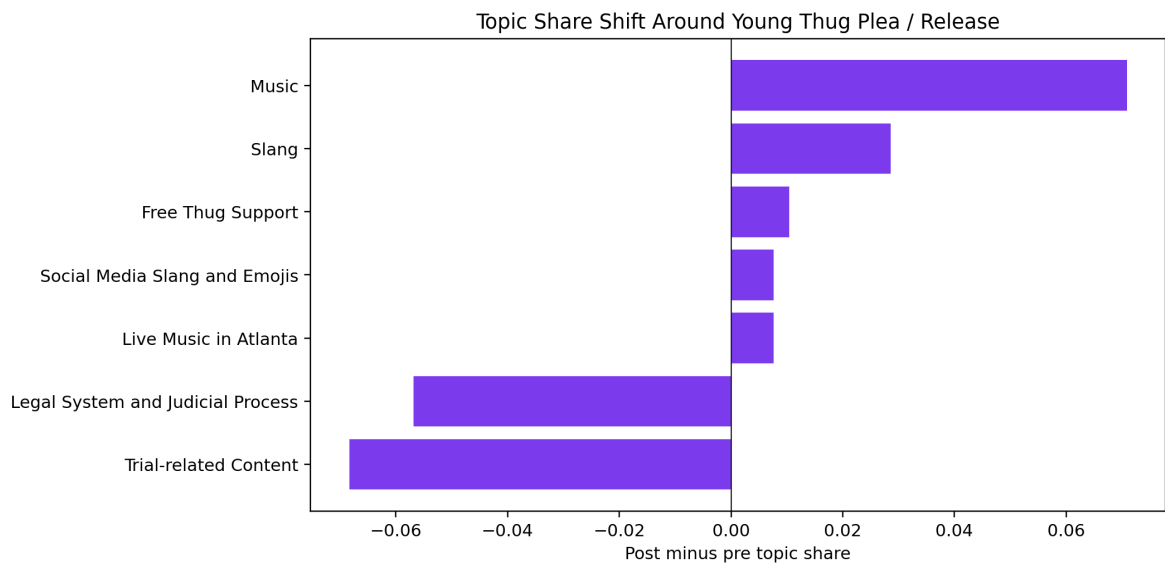


Figure 11: Topic share change around the Young Thug plea/release event.

In the seven-day event window around the October 31, 2024 plea/release, the share of *Music* language increases while the share of *Trial-related Content* and *Legal System and Judicial Process* decreases. This does not mean the legal narrative disappears. It means that as uncertainty resolves, conversation partially rebalances toward music identity, fandom framing, and broader cultural talk.

Topic shifts are especially important for legal-media intelligence because sentiment alone can hide the substantive change. A neutral sentiment score attached to legal-process language may still represent a major public-narrative shift if the conversation moves from music fandom to plea terms, judge behavior, witness credibility, or trial legitimacy.

15 Causal Diagram and Confounding

The core inference problem in this project is confounding. Court events, media coverage, and music releases can all move public outcomes *and* trigger ThuggerDaily posts in the same period. Figure 12 summarizes the conceptual structure.

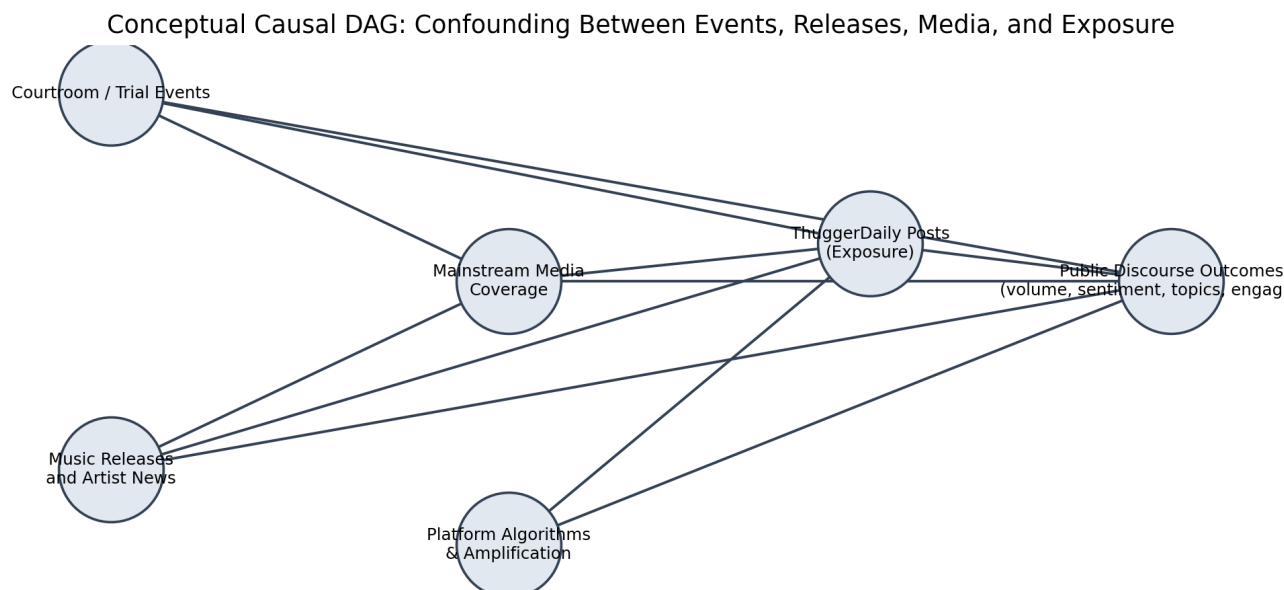


Figure 12: Conceptual causal DAG showing why isolating ThuggerDaily’s effect is difficult without stronger identification. Court events and releases drive mainstream coverage and public outcomes, while platform algorithms influence exposure and amplification.

Read the DAG as an interpretation guide, not a claim of estimated causal coefficients. The question “was the shift driven by a song release, a ThuggerDaily tweet, or a courtroom hearing?” has a disciplined answer here: *all three can contribute*. This dataset is strongest at describing timing and association, and at quantifying how outcomes move in windows where exposure is present.

16 Event-by-Event Interpretive Findings

This section translates the quantitative outputs into a narrative that reads like a report, not a notebook. The goal is to answer: what changed, when did it change, and what is the most defensible interpretation given confounding and platform differences?

16.1 May 2022 Indictment and Arrest

The indictment/arrest window is the baseline shock. It re-anchors the discourse from music-first conversation to a hybrid legal-media conversation with persistent RICO vocabulary. The large post-window volume increase is the expected result of a major public event. This window is not a clean test of ThuggerDaily influence because mainstream coverage and social reaction are both maximal.

16.2 December 2022 Gunna Plea

Plea-related moments tend to polarize fan narratives (loyalty, betrayal, strategic necessity) and create long-tail conversation beyond the immediate news cycle. The event-window results show a large attention shift, while topic and platform composition help diagnose whether the post-window conversation is primarily procedural/legal or identity/fandom-driven.

16.3 November 2023 Lyrics as Evidence

The lyrics ruling is a high-salience framing event: it connects the trial to broader debates about art, criminalization, and evidentiary standards. Even if sentiment does not move dramatically in aggregate, topic shifts can show a rise in legal-process language and media framing terms.

16.4 Opening Statements (Late 2023)

Opening statements are a classic narrative inflection point. They generate quotable claims, interpretable “stories” about what the trial is about, and rapid recirculation through clips and summaries. In this window, ThuggerDaily is most plausibly acting as a transmission and framing node rather than a primary driver of attention.

16.5 June–July 2024 Recusal Crisis

The recusal period is a procedural legitimacy shock. Public discourse can become simultaneously more supportive of the defendant while more negative toward the process. This is exactly where topic analysis matters: it distinguishes “support” language from “procedural fairness” language.

16.6 October 2024 Plea and Release

The October 31, 2024 plea/release is the most important resolution moment for the Young Thug narrative. The defensible claim is not that social media created the outcome, but that accounts like ThuggerDaily can accelerate and shape the public-facing interpretation of the outcome in the immediate post-event window.

16.7 December 2024 Trial End

The end of proceedings for remaining defendants shifts discourse from live uncertainty to retrospective closure. In this phase, amplification accounts function more like memory and framing channels: what is remembered, what is emphasized, and how reputational narratives settle.

17 Cross-Platform Narrative Mechanics

17.1 YouTube as High-Volume Reaction Archive

YouTube dominates the record count because courtroom streams, legal commentary videos, and comment sections produce dense records. That makes YouTube excellent for measuring volume and breadth of reaction, but it also means raw counts overweight comment behavior relative to institutional reporting.

17.2 X/Twitter as Fast Narrative Transmission

X/Twitter is the exposure platform for ThuggerDaily. Its analytical value is speed, timestamp precision, and frame transmission. A single post can compress courtroom information into a shareable claim, which then diffuses into other spaces.

17.3 Institutional Media as Framing Inputs

Newspapers, local news, and magazines have fewer records but high framing value. Their language often becomes the vocabulary that social platforms quote, argue with, or remix.

17.4 Music Signals as Competing Attention Shocks

Spotify and Billboard are not comment platforms, but they capture attention shifts tied to releases and chart movement. Those signals matter because they change the mix of public conversation from legal procedure toward career narrative and identity.

Empirically, this creates a familiar interpretive problem in event windows: a trial hearing can increase legal-topic volume at the same time that a release, feature, chart movement, or music-media cycle increases music-topic volume. In the immediate aftermath of high-salience legal moments, the public narrative can therefore *recompose* rather than move in a single direction. One portion of the ecosystem reacts to courtroom information (motions, plea terms, judge behavior, legitimacy), while another portion pivots toward career trajectory (“what happens to the music?”, “what does this mean for the artist?”, “who is loyal?”). This is why the report treats music sources as **competing attention shocks** and why topic shifts are read as mixture changes: legal-topic increases can coexist with a short-run rise in music attention that partially dilutes purely legal framing even when total volume spikes.

18 Platform Interpretation

The platform composition affects every result. YouTube dominates raw records because video comments and video metadata are dense. X/Twitter is central to the ThuggerDaily exposure

mechanism but is not the largest total record source. Magazines and newspapers provide fewer records but often contain higher-density narrative framing. Spotify and Billboard are not public-opinion platforms, but they provide music-attention signals around album releases and chart movement.

This multi-platform structure is a strength because it prevents the report from equating one platform with the public. It is also a limitation because measurement units differ. A YouTube comment, a tweet, a magazine article, and a Billboard chart row are not identical observations. The dashboard’s role is to make these differences visible while still allowing an integrated public narrative view.

19 What Can Be Said About “Affecting the Trial”

The phrase “affected the trial” needs a disciplined interpretation. Based on this dataset, the correct claim is not that ThuggerDaily altered a judge’s ruling, changed a plea negotiation, or caused legal outcomes. The defensible claim is that ThuggerDaily appears to have affected the *public narrative environment around the trial* by posting near key legal events and potentially amplifying selected frames.

This report should not be used to claim that ThuggerDaily affected judicial decision-making, plea negotiations, witness behavior, or legal outcomes. The evidence supports a narrower public-discourse claim: ThuggerDaily was a visible amplification channel whose activity often coincided with measurable changes in public attention, sentiment, engagement, and topic composition around key legal events.

Three mechanisms are plausible:

1. **Attention amplification:** posts near legal events can increase the number of people who see or discuss the event.
2. **Frame selection:** the account can choose which aspects of courtroom activity become salient to followers.
3. **Sentiment coordination:** repeated support language can strengthen or concentrate fan sentiment around an entity.

These mechanisms are media effects, not legal-causal proof. The report therefore uses the language of temporal association, influence signal, event-linked discourse shift, and public narrative response.

20 Key Findings and Claims

These findings are stated at a level of certainty supported by the data and observational design:

1. The YSL trial period (2022–2024) contains repeated event-linked shifts in public discourse volume, engagement, and topic mix.
2. ThuggerDaily is a measurable exposure stream (773 posts in the processed ThuggerDaily dataset) that is frequently active in the same short windows where public attention moves.
3. The strongest evidence of association appears as short-run, event-conditioned movement (same-day to 7-day windows), not as stable long-run predictive power at daily resolution.
4. Topic shifts provide the clearest interpretation layer: during resolution moments (e.g., the October 2024 plea/release), the conversation partially rebalances from procedural/legal language toward music identity and fandom framing.
5. None of the analyses identify randomized causal effects or legal causation; the correct language is temporal association and public narrative influence signal, not legal-causal responsibility.

21 Operational Implications

In a legal-media intelligence workflow, the results support a practical monitoring posture:

1. **Treat the event calendar as an attention calendar:** courtroom moments and major media stories reliably create short-run volume and engagement spikes.
2. **Monitor amplification nodes:** high-visibility accounts can concentrate attention and frames during post-event windows; their activity is useful as an early indicator of narrative direction.
3. **Separate “tone” from “topic”:** sentiment can stay flat while topic mix shifts meaningfully from music talk to legal process talk (or vice versa).
4. **Keep platform differences explicit:** YouTube is a high-volume reaction archive; X/Twitter is a fast transmission layer; institutional sources are low-volume but high framing value.

22 Project Resources

- GitHub repository: <https://github.com/Sagnik-Chakravarty/ThuggerDaily>
- Live dashboard: <https://narrativepulse.streamlit.app/>
- Data folder (processed exports and artifacts): https://drive.google.com/drive/u/1/folders/1x_FggrtA45kLSCVbbrz3B32iT-Wk1cei

23 Overall Implications and Interpretation

Taken together, the results support a practical interpretation that is stronger than “the account posted a lot” but weaker than “the account caused outcomes.” The YSL trial is a long-running, high-salience public event. That means attention is repeatedly reallocated: major hearings, rulings, and plea moments create sharp bursts of public conversation; music releases and artist news create competing bursts that pull conversation back toward career identity and fandom.

Within that environment, ThuggerDaily is best understood as a **narrative transmission channel**. It compresses complex trial information into fast, legible frames, and it reliably participates in post-event windows when attention is already high. This matters because attention alone is not the story: the public also needs a *story about what the event means*. In those windows, influential accounts can shape interpretation by selecting clips, emphasizing procedural fairness or unfairness, and amplifying support-oriented language.

The data suggest three operational takeaways. First, **event timing dominates**: courtroom shocks and major media coverage are the primary drivers of spikes in public volume and engagement. Second, **influence is episodic**: averaged over multiple years, a single account will rarely look like a strong global predictor; influence shows up when you zoom into the windows that matter. Third, **topic shift is the clearest interpretive signal**: resolution moments can move the conversation away from procedural language and toward music, identity, and fandom framing, even if sentiment changes are modest.

In a professional setting, the right use of this report is to support disciplined situational awareness. It does not tell a legal team what will happen in court. It does tell analysts what the public is paying attention to, how that attention is framed, and when a visible amplification channel is aligned with broader narrative movement. That is the actionable layer: public legitimacy, reputational dynamics, and narrative momentum are not courtroom facts, but they are measurable features of high-profile legal events and they can be monitored with the same discipline applied to other operational risk signals.

24 Limitations

24.1 Observational Design

The analysis is observational. There is no randomized assignment of ThuggerDaily exposure. People who follow or react to ThuggerDaily are not randomly selected from the public. Trial events and posts may be jointly caused by the same news.

24.2 Omitted Confounders

The model does not fully observe all mainstream coverage, private group chats, TikTok, full X/Twitter firehose activity, courtroom livestream reach, or recommendation algorithm exposure. Omitted confounders can explain part of any observed association.

24.3 Platform Bias

The corpus is not platform-balanced. YouTube records dominate the sample. X/Twitter is central to the exposure but not the majority of downstream records. Platform-specific interpretation remains necessary.

24.4 Sentiment Error

Sentiment models can misread slang, sarcasm, legal terms, hip-hop discourse, and fan-coded language. Topic labels are useful abstractions but not perfect semantic truth.

24.5 Engagement Denominators

Engagement-rate denominators are inconsistent across sources. The dashboard uses analytics, impressions, or views where available and falls back to raw engagement where denominators are missing. This makes cross-platform engagement comparisons approximate.

25 Conclusion

The NarrativePulse analysis supports a nuanced conclusion: ThuggerDaily was a measurable public-narrative exposure stream during the YSL RICO trial, but the evidence does not support claims of legal causation. Public discourse shifted in volume, sentiment, engagement, and topic composition around major trial events, and ThuggerDaily activity frequently appeared in the same short-run windows. The strongest signal appears around high-salience legal moments, especially the October 31, 2024 plea/release window, where public attention rose sharply and ThuggerDaily showed substantial post-event activity and engagement.

The appropriate interpretation is therefore not that ThuggerDaily caused trial outcomes, but that it likely contributed to the public narrative environment by amplifying attention, selecting frames, and concentrating fan/support discourse. For legal-media intelligence, this is a meaningful result: public legitimacy, reputational dynamics, and narrative momentum are not courtroom facts, but they are measurable features of high-profile legal events.

26 References

References

- [1] McCombs, M. E., & Shaw, D. L. (1972). The agenda-setting function of mass media. *Public Opinion Quarterly*.
- [2] Entman, R. M. (1993). Framing: Toward clarification of a fractured paradigm. *Journal of Communication*.
- [3] Pearl, J. (2009). *Causality: Models, Reasoning, and Inference*. Cambridge University Press.
- [4] Hernan, M. A., & Robins, J. M. (2020). *Causal Inference: What If*. Chapman & Hall/CRC.
- [5] Angrist, J. D., & Pischke, J.-S. (2009). *Mostly Harmless Econometrics*. Princeton University Press.
- [6] Bertrand, M., Duflo, E., & Mullainathan, S. (2004). How much should we trust differences-in-differences estimates? *Quarterly Journal of Economics*.
- [7] Bernal, J. L., Cummins, S., & Gasparrini, A. (2017). Interrupted time series regression for the evaluation of public health interventions. *International Journal of Epidemiology*.
- [8] Mann, H. B., & Whitney, D. R. (1947). On a test of whether one of two random variables is stochastically larger than the other. *Annals of Mathematical Statistics*.
- [9] Welch, B. L. (1947). The generalization of “Student’s” problem when several different population variances are involved. *Biometrika*.
- [10] Pearson, K. (1900). On the criterion that a given system of deviations from the probable in the case of a correlated system of variables is such that it can be reasonably supposed to have arisen from random sampling. *Philosophical Magazine*.
- [11] Cohen, J. (1988). *Statistical Power Analysis for the Behavioral Sciences* (2nd ed.). Lawrence Erlbaum.
- [12] Blei, D. M., Ng, A. Y., & Jordan, M. I. (2003). Latent Dirichlet Allocation. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*.
- [13] Deerwester, S., Dumais, S. T., Furnas, G. W., Landauer, T. K., & Harshman, R. (1990). Indexing by latent semantic analysis. *Journal of the American Society for Information Science*.
- [14] Jolliffe, I. T. (2002). *Principal Component Analysis* (2nd ed.). Springer.
- [15] Hip Hop History. *A Timeline of Young Thug and YSL’s Atlanta RICO Trial*. <https://history.hiphop/young-thug-trial-timeline/>.

- [16] Pitchfork. *Young Thug's Lyrics Can Be Entered as Evidence in YSL RICO Trial, Judge Rules*. <https://pitchfork.com/news/young-thug-lyrics-can-be-entered-as-evidence-in-ysl-rico-trial-judge-rules/>.
- [17] The FADER. *Prosecutor Quotes The Jungle Book, Reads Young Thug Lyrics in YSL Trial Opening Statement*. <https://www.thefader.com/2023/11/27/prosecutor-quotes-the-jungle-book-reads-young-thug-lyrics-in-ysl-trial-opening-statement>.
- [18] Los Angeles Times. *Judge in Young Thug RICO Case Recused as YSL Trial in Atlanta Goes on Hold Indefinitely*. <https://www.latimes.com/entertainment-arts/music/story/2024-07-15/ysl-trial-young-thug-judge-recused-ural-glanville-rico>.
- [19] NPR. *Young Thug Pleads Guilty in YSL Trial, Will Serve Probation*. <https://www.npr.org/2024/10/31/nx-s1-5174207/young-thug-guilty-plea-ysl-trial>.
- [20] Los Angeles Times. *YSL RICO Trial Ends*. <https://www.latimes.com/entertainment-arts/music/story/2024-12-03/ysl-rico-trial-ends-defendants-not-guilty-young-thug>.

27 Appendix B: Ethical and Legal Communication Note

The dashboard and report should not be used to infer guilt, innocence, or legal truth. The data are public-discourse artifacts. They describe how public channels talked about the trial, not what happened in court as a matter of law. The strongest professional framing is public narrative analytics, legal-media intelligence, and observational event-linked discourse measurement.